

Academic Performance Task, Expectations and Rubric

The Task

Students begin by examining various aspects of Canada's climate. The initial inquiry explores precipitation patterns by ecozone. The task is to create a simple model to determine the effects of climate change. Students are to write a short report outlining how climate change will effect selected ecozones in Canada. The report is to present collected research on the issue of climate change. Student are instructed to include supporting visuals, such as maps, graphs, charts, diagrams, or pictures, in their report.

Expectations

This task gives students the opportunity to demonstrate achievement of the following selected expectations from three strands: Geographic Foundations: Space and Systems; Understanding and Managing Change; and Methods of Geographic Inquiry.

Students will:

1. demonstrate an understanding of how natural and human systems interact within ecozones;
2. analyze the ways in which natural systems interact with human systems, then make predictions about the outcomes of these interactions;
3. research and report on global concerns that affect Canadians (e.g., wilderness protection, economic impact of globalization);
4. predict the consequences of human activities (e.g., agriculture, recreation) on natural systems (e.g., soil depletion, climate change);
5. select and use appropriate methods for displaying geographic data.

Prior Knowledge and Skills

To complete this task, students are expected to be able to demonstrate the following:

- knowledge of the definition of and ecozone;
- knowledge of some of Canada's ecozones and their physical characteristics (e.g. landforms, climate, vegetation, and soils);
- demonstrate an understanding of the regional diversity of Canada's natural systems (e.g., natural vegetation, climate zones) and human systems (e.g., transportation links, urban hierarchies);
- identify the variables that are used to describe the weather, such as: jet stream, front, wind direction, and cloud cover;
- investigate why is weather significant in our lives;
- learn about the climate system in Canada and the global factors: unequal heating of the Earth's surface, climate characteristics, climate graphs, latitude as a climate factor, global wind system, ocean currents, elevation as a climate factor, mountain climates, influence of lakes and oceans and climate change;
- understanding of research methods using a variety of source materials;
- ability to read, analyze, and interpret graphs and maps;
- ability to use a variety of tools and technologies for research;
- demonstrate an understanding of the characteristics of natural systems (e.g., climate, landforms, soils, natural vegetation, wildlife);
- demonstrate an understanding of the methods used to collect, organize, manipulate, and interpret geographic data.

Task Rubric – Climate Change						
Expectations	Criteria	Level 1 (50 – 59)	Level 2 (60 –69)	Level 3 (70 – 79)	Level 4 (80 -100)	
<u>Knowledge / understanding</u>						
1	Demonstrates understanding of the relationship between natural and human systems	Demonstrates limited understanding of the relationship between natural and human systems	Demonstrates some understanding of the relationship between natural and human systems	Demonstrates considerable understanding of the relationship between natural and human systems	Demonstrates thorough understanding of the relationship between natural and human systems	
<u>Thinking / Inquiry</u>						
4	Predicts the consequences of human activities (e.g., agriculture, recreation) on natural systems (e.g., soil depletion, climate change);	Shows little prediction of the consequences of human activities on natural systems	Shows some predictions of the consequences of human activities on natural systems	Shows considerable prediction of the consequences of human activities on natural systems	Predicts the consequences of human activities on natural systems to a high degree	
<u>Communication</u>						
3,5	Writes a clear and convincing report on global concerns that affect Canadians	Writes a report that is not very clear or convincing on global concerns that affect Canadians	Writes a report that is somewhat clear and convincing on global concerns that affect Canadians	Writes a report that is generally clear and convincing on global concerns that affect Canadians	Writes a report that is very clear and convincing on global concerns that affect Canadians	
<u>Application</u>						
2	Analyses the ways in which natural systems interact with human systems, then make predictions about the outcomes of these interactions	Demonstrates little analyses of the ways in which natural systems interact with human systems	Demonstrates some analyses of the ways in which natural systems interact with human systems	Demonstrates considerable analyses of the ways in which natural systems interact with human systems	Analyses the ways in which natural systems interact with human systems to a high degree	